

Re: Application for the EngD position, Developing an Interactive Reverse Logistics Map for Circular Construction (CIRCOLOGIC), University of Twente

Dear Professor Marc & Selection Team,

I am writing to apply for the EngD position on the interactive reverse logistics map for circular construction (CIRCOLOGIC). This is a topic I really care about. In construction we are already good at taking buildings apart, but a lot of good material still ends up as waste. The main problem is information. People often do not know which materials are available, in what condition, where they are, or when they will need them. So they choose new materials instead of reused ones. A map that shows what is available, a way to calculate cost and CO2, and a simple way to compare options would make reuse a much easier choice. That is the kind of solution I would like to help build.

While preparing this application, I read some of Professor Voordijk's work on recovering building elements for reuse. One idea really stayed with me: reuse does not work because of technology alone, but because of how well all the parties work together, from the donor building where the material comes from to the target building where it is used again. This was exactly my own thinking when I chose my master's thesis on Agile methods in construction. Good projects need clear communication and shared information, not only good technology, and when everyone works as one team the result is better and there is more value.

That thesis left me with one question: what happens to materials when a building is taken down, and why is reuse still so hard? For me the answer came back to information and decisions. That is why I want to move from running projects to helping build the digital solutions that bring the right information to the right people.

My recent jobs also prepare me for this project. At Aug.e I worked on digital twins for smart buildings. We used a digital environment to understand and improve how a real building performs. For CIRCOLOGIC I see the same idea, but applied to materials: where they are, what can be reused, who is involved, and how they move through reverse logistics. At Hive CPQ I managed large manufacturer datasets and turned complex product information into simple digital solutions that non-technical users could work with. That is close to what CIRCOLOGIC needs: organising material, location and stakeholder information, connecting data from many parties, and making a reverse-logistics map easy for non-technical people to use. At iostRING I worked on a circular construction hypothesis, looking at how Agile project management can bring circular practices into real delivery. With my civil and environmental engineering background and my GIS skills, I can help build this solution and make sure people will really use it.

For the last while I have taken a break from work to take care of my newborns. During this time I kept learning on my own about circular construction, reverse logistics and GIS. This EngD is the perfect way for me to come back to work. I can use what I already know, learn more, and this time apply it to a real project in industry and not only in theory.

I would really like to do this at the University of Twente. I like that the university works closely with industry, and that the EngD combines study with a real design project together with partners like Dura Vermeer and TNO. I learn best when I can use new methods straight away and improve them with the people I work with.

I would be very happy to work on CIRCOLOGIC and to grow as an engineer who builds solutions that people actually use. I would be glad to talk more about how I can fit into the project. Thank you for reading my application.

Yours sincerely,
Pooja Awasare